FPO · GETTY 1894176389

FIELD GUIDE NO. 06
COMPLIMENTARY
WITH JAMES'S COMPLIMENTS

JAMES WILD & CO.
LEDGERED & VETTED
JOURNEY DESIGN SINCE 1982

JAMES WILD & CO.

BELIZE

THE REEF, THE JUNGLE AND THE BLUE HOLE

A complimentary field guide to Belize, from the barrier reef to the Maya cities of Cayo.

"Jungle first, then the reef."

— JAMES WILD, CHIEF EXPEDITION OFFICER

JAMES WILD & CO.
I KNOW A PLACE
BELIZE · VETTED 2006

PREPARED FOR
Jane Traveler

IGGI'S COMPASS

START HERE
MEET IGGI

FIELD GUIDE NO. 06 · EDITION 2027
FOLIO JW-F-0006
COVER: THE GREAT BLUE HOLE · GETTY IMAGES



HI, I'M IGGI · JAMES'S TRIP-BUILDING BUDDY

Every place in here has a page number. Circle the ones that make you grin, then find **Iggi's Compass** on the Belize page at jameswildco.com. Tell me your month and your crew; I'll sketch the route, James takes it from there. *Never lost. Only scenic.*

Dear Jane,

I first went to Belize in 2006, and I've been sending people there ever since. I dove the Great Blue Hole and the walls of Lighthouse Reef, walked the Maya cities, and slept at Hidden Valley and The Lodge at Chaa Creek back when the country was only starting to open up. Then I crossed the border to Tikal, which I still think nobody should miss. I went back several times between 2014 and 2016.

Belize is small, and that's the point. You can wake up in the rainforest of Cayo and fall asleep two hours later on a caye in the Caribbean. English is the official language, the reef runs almost the length of the coast, and the jungle still hides more temples than anyone has cleared.

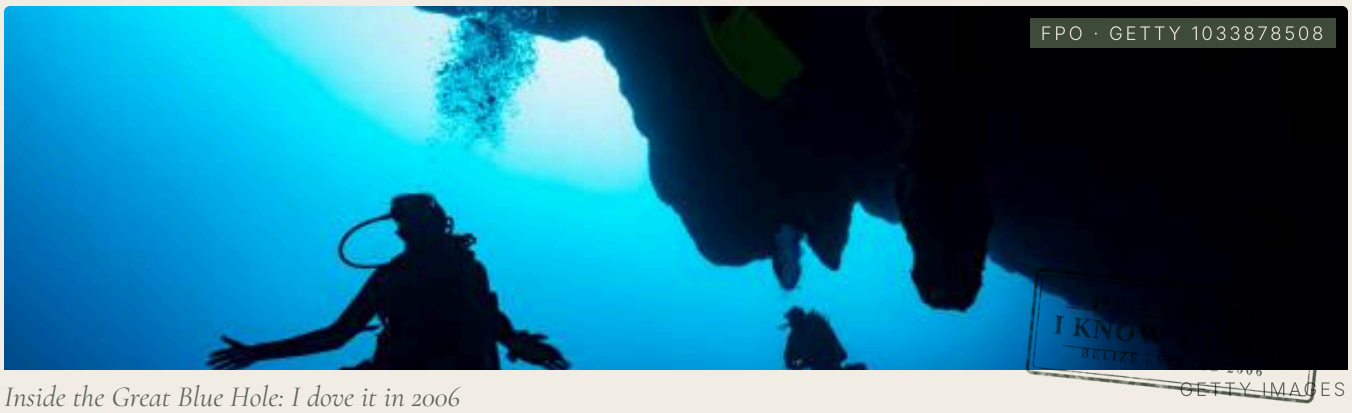
Belize shows how adventure and ease can exist together. Do the jungle first, then the reef, and give each one three nights. That's what this guide is for.

J. Wild CHIEF EXPEDITION OFFICER · VETTED BELIZE 2006

BARRIER REEF
about 300 km
The longest in the Northern and Western Hemispheres (UNESCO, 1996)

CAYES
about 450
Sand and mangrove islands, plus three of the region's four atolls

PEOPLE
397,483
Belize's 2022 Census, the latest official count



Inside the Great Blue Hole: I dove it in 2006

Contents

Read it in order, jungle to reef. Or start with the page that made you pick it up. Each part has its own colour, at the top of every page.

WELCOME · PLAN · EXPLORE · STAY & PREPARE · FOR THE CURIOUS

YOUR NOTES

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HOW TO READ THE MARKS

● I KNOW A PLACE	James has stayed or sailed there himself.
● I DOVE IT	James has dived it himself.
● I KEEP GOING BACK	A founder favourite.
● I KNOW WHO KNOWS	Vetted through a partner we trust.
● I'LL KNOW SOON	On James's list, honestly marked.

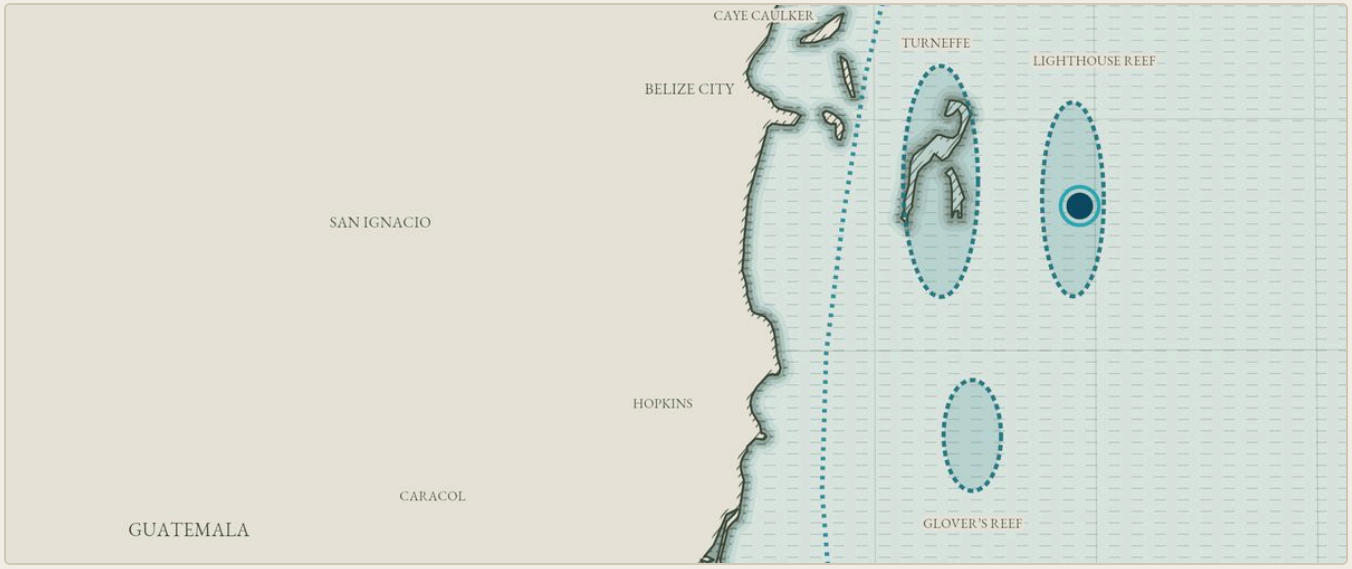
THE COLOURS OF THIS GUIDE

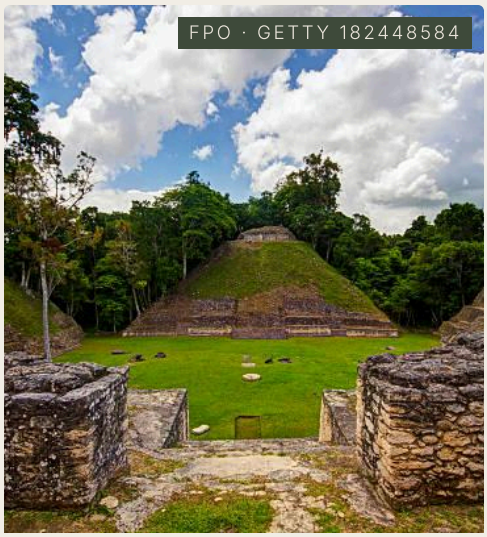
Rainforest green and sand from Cayo, with the turquoise of the reef and the deep navy of the Blue Hole.

RAINFOREST · REEF · BLUE HOLE · SAND · LINEN

Where the jungle meets the sea

Why visit Belize: the longest barrier reef in this half of the world, Maya cities in the rainforest, and both within a short flight of each other.





Caracol, the great city of Cayo GETTY IMAGES

A reef you can swim to

The Belize Barrier Reef Reserve System covers seven protected sites, from Bacalar Chico to the Sapodilla Cayes, including the Blue Hole and Half Moon Caye. UNESCO took it off its “in danger” list in 2018.

A jungle full of cities

Caracol’s Caana rises 43 m, still the tallest building in Belize. Lamanai, Xunantunich and Altun Ha are a drive or a river trip away, and Tikal is across the border.

Many cultures, one language

Kriol, Garifuna, Maya and Mestizo towns, with English as the official language. Garifuna music and dance are on UNESCO’s heritage list.

> *People come for the Blue Hole and leave talking about the jungle. Plan for both.*
> — J. WILD

Dry for the reef, green for the jungle

The best time to visit Belize: November to May for the dry season, calm seas and the Caracol road; June to November for the green season, fewer people and lower rates.

	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Season	dry	dry	dry	dry	dry	green	green	green	green	green	dry	dry
Whale sharks, Gladden Spit	·	·	●	●	●	●	·	·	·	·	·	·
Scarlet macaws, Red Bank	●	●	●	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	●
Lobster on the menu	●	●	·	·	·	·	●	●	●	●	●	●
Garifuna Settlement Day	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	●	·

NOVEMBER – MAY

The dry season

January is the coolest month and April the driest. Best for Blue Hole days, the ATM cave and the road to Caracol. Christmas and Easter book out early.

JUNE – NOVEMBER

The green season

Afternoon showers, a dry spell in August, warm seas. Storm risk peaks in September, when some lodges close.



Dry season: Half Moon Caye GETTY IMAGES



Green season: the Macal River GETTY IMAGES

> *Whale sharks come to Gladden Spit around the full moons of March to June. If that's your reason, tell me first and I'll pick the dates.*
>
> — J. WILD

Seasons from Belize's National Meteorological Service. Lobster is closed 1 March to 30 June since 2024. Whale-shark dates move with the moon; check each year.

Who Belize is for, and who it isn't

The short answer: anyone who wants the sea and the rainforest on the same trip. Here's how I'd match you.

BEST FOR	IDEAL LENGTH	BEST TIME	HOW
Divers, families and anyone who wants jungle and reef together	7 to 10 days; add 1 for Tikal	Nov–May dry; whale sharks Mar–Jun	Lodges and short hops, or a liveaboard

MADE FOR YOU IF YOU'RE…

First-timers
Jungle and reef in one week, with short hops between.

OUR PICK · JUNGLE, THEN REEF · 8 DAYS

Divers
The Blue Hole, three atolls and the walls of Lighthouse Reef.

OUR PICK · BELIZE AGGRESSOR IV, OR SAN PEDRO DAYS

Families
Butterflies, canoes, howler monkeys and snorkelling.

OUR PICK · CHAA CREEK, THEN PLACENCIA

Couples & honeymooners
A private island, or a cabana over a waterfall.

OUR PICK · CAYO ESPANTO OR GAIA RIVERLODGE

History lovers
Caracol, Lamanai, Xunantunich, and Tikal next door.

OUR PICK · THE MAYA ROAD · 10 DAYS

Food people
Cacao, hudut, fry jacks and lobster from July.

OUR PICK · COPAL TREE LODGE, TOLEDO

THINK TWICE IF YOU'RE…

Beach-only travellers
The beaches are narrow and sargassum is expected in 2026.

OUR PICK · A PRIVATE CAYE, OR THE REEF BY BOAT

Divers in a hurry
Blue Hole days start at 6 am, 2.5 hours each way.

OUR PICK · GO LIVEABOARD INSTEAD

Limited mobility
ATM means swimming, wading and climbing in the dark.

OUR PICK · LAMANAI BY RIVER BOAT AND XUNANTUNICH

Big-resort fans
Most of the best stays have 7 to 32 rooms.

OUR PICK · ITZ'ANA, OR ALAIA ON AMBERGRIS

Anyone who hates heat
May is hot and the jungle is humid all year.

OUR PICK · MOUNTAIN PINE RIDGE IS COOLER

Age and fitness rules vary by tour and operator [confirm per program]. Not sure where you fit? Ask Iggi, or call me.



The Placencia peninsula: 41 km of sand

WILD EARTH STAYS

Six places worth the crossing

Where to go in Belize, from the northern cayes to the deep south, with the mark each place has earned.

JAMES SAYS DON'T MISS THIS ONE



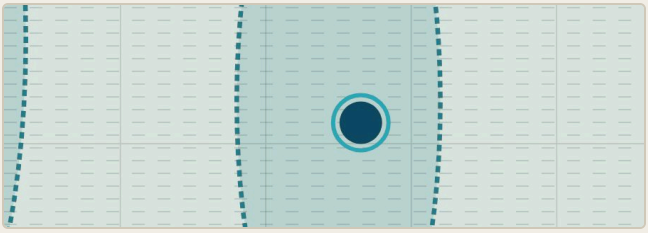
Ambergris & Caye Caulker

I'LL KNOW SOON

The northern cayes

San Pedro, Hol Chan ("little channel") and Shark Ray Alley, then Caye Caulker's sand streets and no cars.

SNORKEL & DIVE · JUNGLE, THEN REEF



Lighthouse Reef & the Blue Hole

I DOVE IT

The outer atoll

The Great Blue Hole, about 300 m across, the walls of Half Moon Caye and its 4,000 red-footed boobies.

DIVE & FLY · THE BLUE HOLE, PROPERLY



Cayo District

I KNOW A PLACE

Rivers & ruins

San Ignacio, Xunantunich, Caracol, the ATM cave, the Macal River and Mountain Pine Ridge. Tikal is across the border.

RUINS & RIVERS · THE MAYA ROAD



Placencia

I'LL KNOW SOON

The southern peninsula

Forty-one kilometres of sand, and whale sharks at Gladden Spit around the spring full moons.

BEACH & BOATS · THE MAYA ROAD · END



Hopkins & Cockscomb

I'LL KNOW SOON

Garifuna coast

Drums in Hopkins, and Cockscomb, the world's first jaguar preserve, set up in 1986.

CULTURE & JUNGLE · THE MAYA ROAD



Toledo

I'LL KNOW SOON

The deep south

Cacao farms, Maya villages, the Chocolate Festival in May and the Sapodilla Cayes offshore.

FOOD & VILLAGES · ADD-ON

James first vetted Belize in 2006 and returned in 2014–16. Places are marked "I'll know soon" until he has been to each one himself.

Who you'll meet

Belize wildlife by place and season: manatees, jaguars, toucans, macaws, howler monkeys and boobies, and where to look for each.

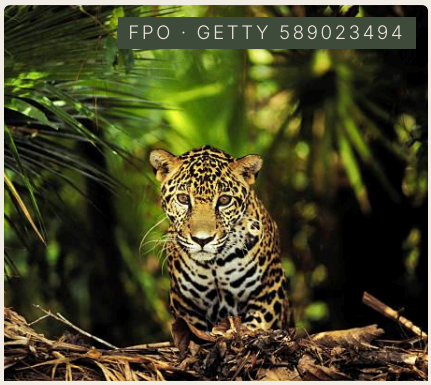


GETTY IMAGES

Antillean manatee

SWALLOW CAYE & THE LAGOONS

About 1,000 live here, the region's highest density. Touching them is illegal.

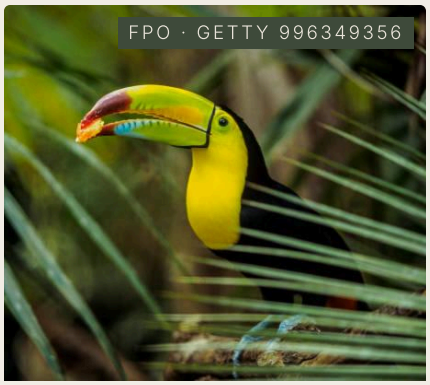


GETTY IMAGES

Jaguar

COCKSCOMB BASIN

About 200 in the world's first jaguar preserve. You'll see tracks; sightings are rare.



GETTY IMAGES

Keel-billed toucan

EVERYWHERE IN THE FOREST

The national bird. The national animal is Baird's tapir, the "mountain cow".



GETTY IMAGES

Scarlet macaw

RED BANK · DECEMBER–MARCH

They come down to feed on annatto in a single Maya village.



GETTY IMAGES

Black howler monkey

BERMUDIAN LANDING & CAYO

Locals call them baboons. The Community Baboon Sanctuary began in 1985.



GETTY IMAGES

Red-footed booby

HALF MOON CAYE

About 4,000 breed here, the only viable colony in the Western Caribbean.

Also look for whale sharks at Gladden Spit (March–June), nurse sharks and southern stingrays at Hol Chan, and crocodiles on the river to Lamanai. Sightings are never guaranteed.

Reef, jungle, or both

A liveaboard to the atolls, a road through the Maya cities, or a lodge in each: how the Belize options compare.

	BY SEA · THE BLUE HOLE, PROPERLY	BY LAND · THE MAYA ROAD	BOTH · JUNGLE, THEN REEF
Where you sleep	One cabin on Belize Aggressor IV	Four lodges, two or three nights each	Three nights in Cayo, four on a caye
Reach	Turneffe, Lighthouse Reef, Half Moon Caye, the Blue Hole	Lamanai, Cayo, Caracol, ATM, Cockscomb, Placencia	Chaa Creek, then Ambergris
Pace	Up to five dives a day	Two hours' driving at most	Slow, then slower
Suits	Certified divers	History lovers, families	First-timers, couples
Nights · from	7 · $[____] pp	9 · $[____] pp	7 · $[____] pp



The Blue Hole from a Tropic Air window GETTY IMAGES



By river to Lamanai, about 45 minutes GETTY IMAGES

THE LINGER-O-METER · THE SAME COUNTRY AT THREE SPEEDS

4
DAYS · ONE CAYE

Hol Chan, one Blue Hole day, a lot of hammock.

You miss: the jungle, the ruins, Tikal.

7
DAYS · JUNGLE, THEN REEF

Three nights in Cayo, four on Ambergris.

You miss: the south and the whale sharks.

10
DAYS · THE JAMES WILD WAY

Cayo, a day at Tikal, then the reef and Placencia.

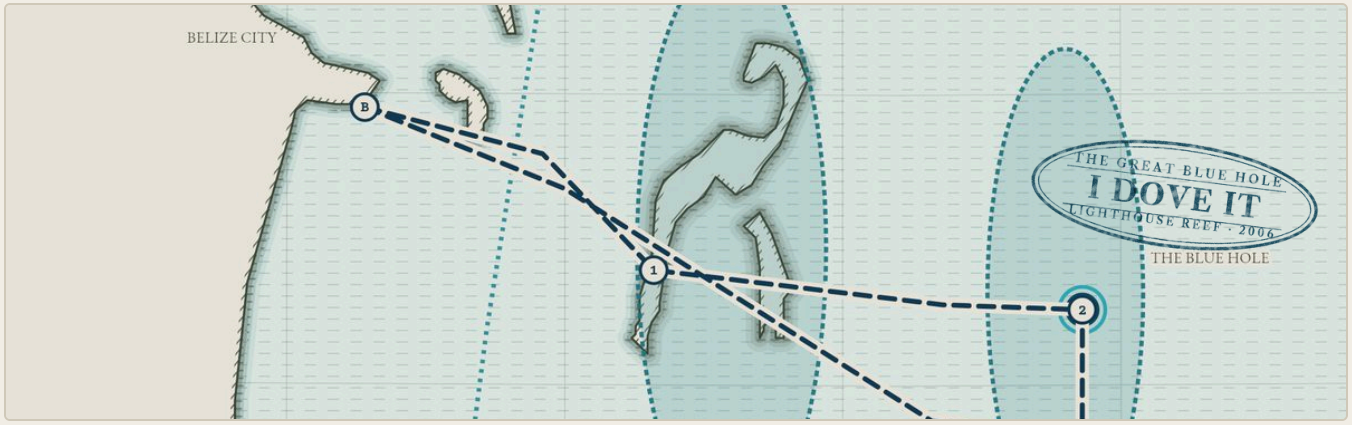
You miss: nothing but the office.



The Blue Hole, properly

BELIZE AGGRESSOR IV · LIVEABOARD FROM BELIZE CITY · 7 NIGHTS · UP TO 20 GUESTS

● I DOVE IT · THE BLUE HOLE



B Belize City · 1 Turneffe Atoll · 2 The Great Blue Hole · 3 Half Moon Caye, Lighthouse Reef. Sites as published by the operator; the order changes with the weather.



Turneffe, the biggest atoll GETTY IMAGES



Lighthouse Reef GETTY IMAGES



Half Moon Caye GETTY IMAGES

DAY 1	**Belize City.** Board Belize Aggressor IV, 138 ft, 10 cabins. Sail on Saturday.
DAYS 2–3	**Turneffe Atoll.** Belize's largest atoll, a marine reserve since 2012.
DAYS 4–5	**Lighthouse Reef.** The Great Blue Hole at dawn, then the Half Moon Caye wall.
DAY 6	**Half Moon Caye.** Ashore to the booby colony, Belize's oldest protected area (1928).
DAY 7	**Back to Turneffe.** Last dives, then the run home.
DAY 8	**Belize City.** Disembark. Add Cayo before you fly.

WHO IT SUITS

Certified divers who want the atolls without the 6 am boat ride, and non-diving partners who love the sea.

FROM

$[____] pp · 7 nights

TIME REWARDED

Add three nights at Chaa Creek before you board: [__].

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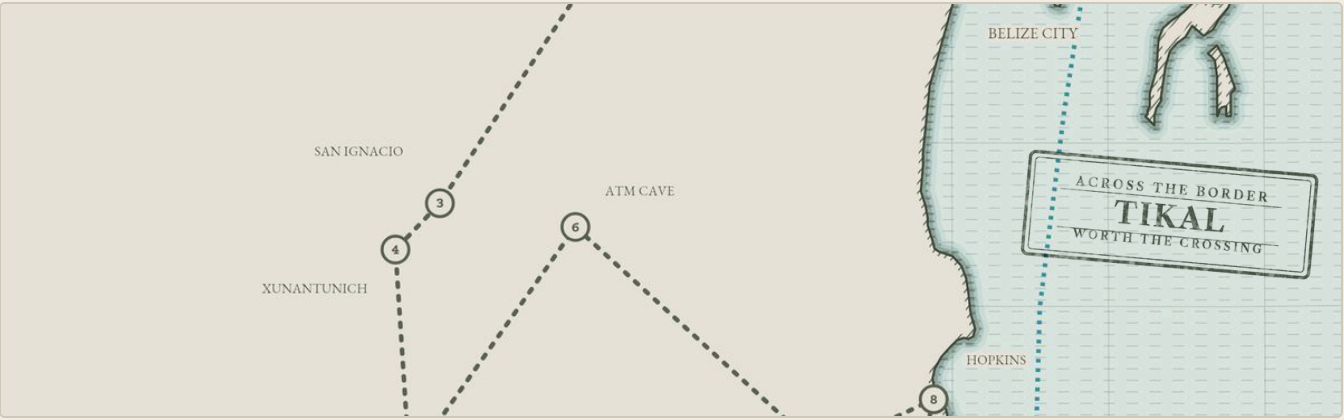
Like this one? Tap Iggi's Compass and start from this route.

> *I dove the Blue Hole in 2006. Go early, go deep only if your logbook says so, and look up at the stalactites.*
> — J. WILD

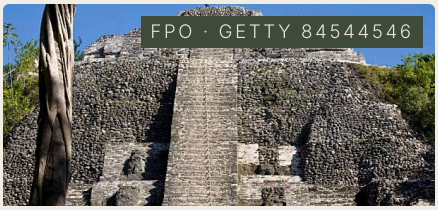
The Maya road

SAMPLE JOURNEY · PRIVATE GUIDE · 10 DAYS · FOUR LODGES

● I KNOW A PLACE · CAYO & TIKAL



BZE the airport · 1 Altun Ha · 2 Lamanai · 3 San Ignacio · 4 Xunantunich · 5 Caracol · 6 ATM cave · 7 Cockscomb · 8 Hopkins · 9 Placencia. Tikal as a day trip from Cayo. Sample route; we set it by season.



Lamanai, day 2 GETTY IMAGES



Xunantunich, day 4 GETTY IMAGES



Tikal, day 5 GETTY IMAGES

DAY 1–2	**Lamanai.** Altun Ha on the way, then 45 minutes up the New River to the "submerged crocodile".
DAY 3–4	**Cayo.** Chaa Creek on the Macal River; Xunantunich across the hand-cranked ferry.
DAY 5	**Tikal.** Over the border at Benque Viejo for the day. Bring quetzales.
DAY 6	**Caracol or ATM.** Caracol by escorted road, or the ATM cave in socks.
DAY 7–8	**Hidden Valley.** Mountain Pine Ridge, King Vulture Falls, cooler nights.
DAY 9–10	**Cockscomb to Placencia.** Jaguar country, Garifuna drums in Hopkins, then the sea.

WHO IT SUITS

History lovers, families with older children, and anyone who would rather walk a pyramid than lie by a pool.

FROM

$[____] pp · 9 nights

WORTH ANOTHER NIGHT

A fourth night in Cayo: [offer to confirm].

WAN-BLZ-JW-F-0006

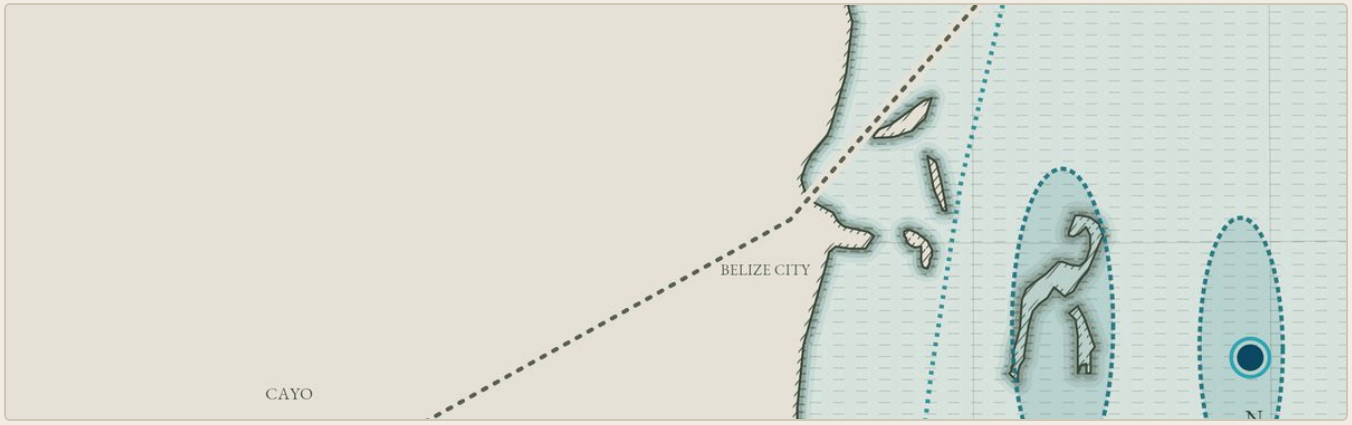
Like this one? Tap Iggi's Compass and start from this route.

> *Tikal is close to Chaa Creek and it's a must. I've crossed for it and I'd do it again tomorrow.*
> — J. WILD

Jungle, then reef

SAMPLE JOURNEY · 3 NIGHTS IN CAYO, THEN 4 ON AMBERGRIS CAYE · 8 DAYS

● I KEEP GOING BACK · THE JAMES WILD WAY



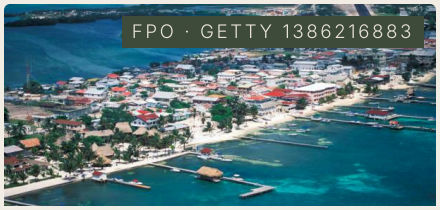
Three nights in Cayo · a 15-minute flight from Belize City · four nights on Ambergris, with one day out to the Blue Hole.



The Macal River by canoe GETTY IMAGES



Hol Chan, day 5 GETTY IMAGES



San Pedro, Ambergris GETTY IMAGES

DAY 1–3	**Cayo.** Chaa Creek or Hidden Valley. Canoes, ruins, the butterfly farm.
DAY 4	**Fly to the reef.** Belize City to San Pedro in about 15 minutes.
DAY 5–7	**Ambergris Caye.** Hol Chan, Shark Ray Alley, a Blue Hole day or a Tropic Air flight over it.
DAY 8	**Fly home.** Nonstops from Miami, Houston, Dallas and Atlanta.

WHO IT SUITS

First-timers, couples and anyone with a week, who wants both halves of Belize without rushing either.

FROM

$[____] pp · 7 nights

JUNGLE, THEN REEF RATE

Both lodges, priced together: [__].

LTS-BLZ-JW-F-0006

Like this one? Tap Iggi's Compass and start from this route.

> *Always the jungle first. Arrive dusty, leave salty. It's the right way round.*
> — J. WILD

Every boat and plane we'd put you on

The liveaboard, the yachts and the small planes that reach the atolls, and the river boats and canoes that reach the jungle.

PARTNER PHOTO TO COME
Belize Aggressor IV
AGGRESSOR ADVENTURES

Belize Aggressor IV

LIVEABOARD · 138 FT · 10 CABINS, UP TO 20 GUESTS

Saturdays from Belize City to Turneffe, Lighthouse Reef, Half Moon Caye and the Blue Hole.

PARTNER PHOTO TO COME
Catamarans
THE MOORINGS

Catamarans

SAIL & POWER · PLACENCIA BASE

Crewed or skippered from Laru Beya. Bareboat needs experience; the outer atolls need a local skipper.

PARTNER PHOTO TO COME
Flightseeing
TROPIC AIR

Flightseeing

ONE-HOUR BLUE HOLE FLIGHTS

Scheduled from San Pedro, Caye Caulker and Belize City Municipal, or a private charter.

ON THE WATER, IN THE AIR, UP THE RIVER EXPLORE



GETTY IMAGES

River boats

Up the New River to Lamanai, about 45 minutes. Watch for crocodiles in the lilies.



GETTY IMAGES

Charter boats

Day trips to the cayes and the southern atolls, and a cabin for the night if you like.



GETTY IMAGES

Kayaks & canoes

The Macal River from Chaa Creek, and the mangroves around the cayes.



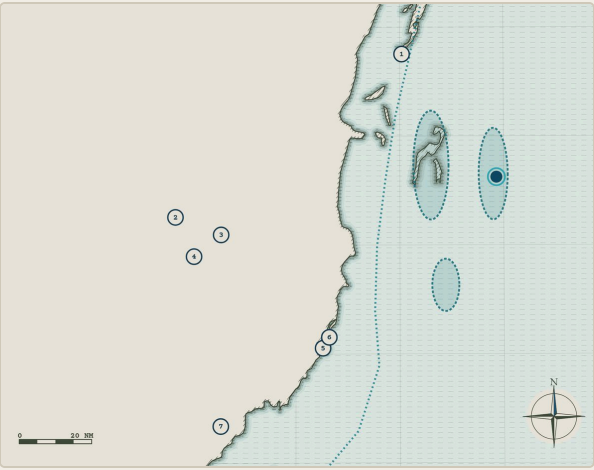
Glover's Reef, the southern atoll: by charter boat

GETTY IMAGES

> *Small planes are the secret. Tropic Air and Maya Island Air turn a three-hour drive into a 20-minute hop.*
> — J. WILD

Seven stays, from the jungle to the cayes

The best luxury lodges and resorts in Belize, from a private island off San Pedro to a cacao farm in Toledo.



1 Cayo Espanto · 2 The Lodge at Chaa Creek · 3 Hidden Valley Wilderness Lodge · 4 Gaia Riverlodge · 5 Turtle Inn · 6 Itz'ana Resort & Residences · 7 Copal Tree Lodge

> *I slept at Chaa Creek and Hidden Valley when the jungle lodges were new. Both are still on my list for first-timers.*
>
> — J. WILD

Want a big resort on Ambergris? Alaia, Belize's first Marriott, opened in 2021.

1 Cayo Espanto

● I'LL KNOW SOON

PRIVATE ISLAND · OFF SAN PEDRO

7 villas with plunge pools and your own houseman; all meals; four-night minimum.

Best for: Couples, and nobody else

2 The Lodge at Chaa Creek

● I KNOW A PLACE

MACAL RIVER · CAYO

About 23 cottages and villas on a private reserve since 1981; butterfly farm, Maya medicinal trail, canoes.

Best for: Families and first-timers

3 Hidden Valley Wilderness Lodge

● I KNOW A PLACE

MOUNTAIN PINE RIDGE

A 7,200-acre private reserve with King Vulture Falls and Butterfly Falls on the property.

Best for: Waterfalls and birders

4 Gaia Riverlodge

● I'LL KNOW SOON

MOUNTAIN PINE RIDGE

16 cabanas above Five Sisters Falls, hydro-powered. Two Michelin Keys, the top score in Belize.

Best for: Couples

5 Turtle Inn

● I'LL KNOW SOON

PLACENCIA · FAMILY COPPOLA HIDEAWAYS

25 cottages and villas on the beach, two infinity pools and three restaurants.

Best for: Barefoot luxury

6 Itz'ana Resort & Residences

● I'LL KNOW SOON

PLACENCIA

32 rooms, lofts and villas; one villa has a 22 m lap pool.

Best for: Families and groups

7 Copal Tree Lodge

● I'LL KNOW SOON

TOLEDO

16 suites and a villa on a 3,000-acre organic farm, with chocolate and rum made next door.

Best for: Food lovers

Details from the properties' and trade listings; confirm with each property. Partner photography to follow.



Slower is the whole point

Why three nights in each place is the house minimum, and the offers that reward staying longer.

HOUSE RULE
3 NIGHTS
JUNGLE OR REEF



From our Belize portfolio — WILD EARTH STAYS

Most Belize regrets are about splitting the week too many ways. Two nights in the jungle is a transfer. Three is a place.

> *Three nights or don't bother. Night one you hear the howlers. Night two you sleep through them. Night three you miss them.*
> — J. WILD

TIME REWARDED

Jungle, then reef

Three nights in Cayo plus four on a caye, [__]% off the jungle nights.

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WORTH ANOTHER NIGHT

A fourth night in Cayo

[offer to confirm with the lodge]

WAN-BLZ-JW-F-0006

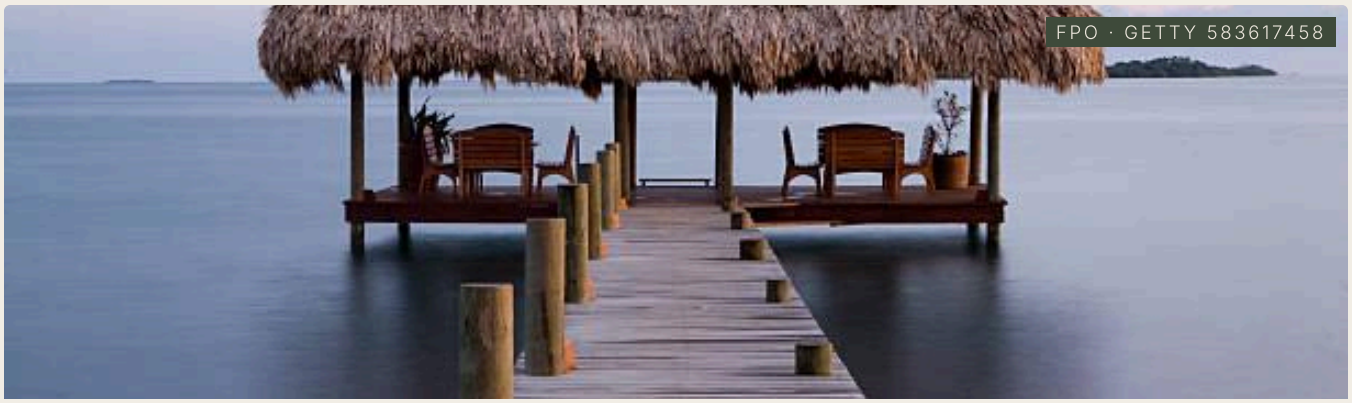
ON THE HORIZON

Not this year? Next.

Whale-shark season 2028 with early-planner savings of [__].

OTH-BLZ-JW-F-0006

Codes are tied to your Folio ID so your advisor sees which offer you chose.



The south, at the end of the day — GETTY IMAGES

The Belize entries

Every place, boat and lodge carries one mark. It tells you exactly how well we know it.

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ENTRY	PLACE	MARK	MARGIN NOTE
L-601	Belize · the country	I KEEP GOING BACK	*First in 2006, back several times in 2014–16. I've sold it ever since.*
L-602	The Great Blue Hole & Lighthouse Reef	I DOVE IT	*Dove it in 2006. Still the dive people ask me about most.*
L-603	The Lodge at Chaa Creek · Cayo	I KNOW A PLACE	*Slept here early on, when the jungle lodges were new.*
L-604	Hidden Valley · Mountain Pine Ridge	I KNOW A PLACE	*Slept here too. Go for the falls and the cool nights.*
L-605	Tikal · Guatemala	I KNOW A PLACE	*Close to Chaa Creek, and a must.*
L-606	Gaia Riverlodge & Copal Tree	I'LL KNOW SOON	*New since my last visit. On the list.*

Every mark is confirmed by James before release.

RULES OF THE ROAD

STAY & PREPARE

01 **Look, don't touch.** Touching a manatee is illegal. Stingrays and corals deserve the same.

02 **Leave the camera at ATM.** Cameras have been banned since 2012.

03 **Drink bottled water.** Tap water isn't considered safe.

04 **Book Christmas and Easter early.** The best lodges have 7 to 32 rooms.

WORDS WE'VE STRUCK OUT

STAY & PREPARE

~~hidden gem~~	The Blue Hole is on every screensaver. The jungle is the part people miss.
~~unspoiled paradise~~	It's a real country with real roads. That's what makes it easy.
~~swim with the sharks~~	They're nurse sharks. Gentle, and you still keep your hands to yourself.

What to know, and what not to expect

Getting to Belize, entry rules, money and straight answers.

Getting there

Nonstops into Belize City (BZE) from Miami, Dallas, Houston and Atlanta, most under five hours. Then a 15-minute hop to Ambergris, or about two hours by road to San Ignacio. Belize is on UTC−6 all year.

Entry

US citizens need a passport book, not a card, with a blank page; no visa for up to 30 days. Arrival forms can be filled in online at BZE. Departure tax is in your airfare.

Tikal

Leaving by land costs BZ$40 (US$20). The park fee is Q150, paid at the gate, and there are no ATMs at the ruins.

Money & plugs

BZ$2 = US$1 since 1976, and US dollars are taken almost everywhere. Tip 10–15%. Plugs are US type, 110 V.

What not to expect

~~Wide white beaches~~	The reef keeps the surf off; the sand is narrow.
~~A quick Blue Hole~~	A full day from San Pedro, 2.5 hours each way.
~~Lobster in spring~~	Closed 1 March to 30 June.
~~Tap water~~	Bottled or filtered, please.
~~Big resorts~~	Small lodges are the point.

Straight answers

Safe? The US advises increased caution; Southside Belize City is the part to skip.

Diving the Blue Hole? Some operators want 25 logged dives for the deep profile.

Children? A great fit. Age limits apply at ATM and on some dives [confirm per program].



IGGI'S PACKING LIST FOR BELIZE

- ☐ Passport book with a blank page
- ☐ Dive card and logbook
- ☐ A light rain shell, June to November
- ☐ Small US bills, and quetzales for Tikal
- ☐ Socks and a warm layer for ATM
- ☐ Binoculars for macaws and boobies
- ☐ A filter bottle
- ☐ Reef-friendly sunscreen and a rash guard



Words you'll hear on the road

Weh gaan ahn?
Kriol for "How are things going?"

Unu
Kriol for "you", more than one of you.

Fu chroo?
Really? Is that true?

Yuh aarite?
Are you OK?

Boil up
The Kriol classic: fish or pig tail, eggs, cassava, plantain and yam.

Fry jack
Fried flour bread at breakfast.

Hudut
Garifuna fish in coconut broth with mashed plantain.

Punta
Garifuna drum music and dance, on UNESCO's list since 2001.

Hol Chan
Maya for "little channel", the cut in the reef.

Lamanai
"Submerged crocodile." You'll see why on the river.

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COLOPHON
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Garifuna drums, Settlement Day, 19 November

GETTY IMAGES

> *Learn one phrase, weh gaan ahn, and you'll get a story back every time.*
> — J. WILD

Your journey, in your hand

Fill it in, snap a photo and send it to James, or tap Iggi's Compass and answer the same questions online.

YOUR TRAVELER FOLIO
SEND IT BACK
JAMES READS EVERY MARK

When I'd like to go	
Who's coming	
Reef, jungle or both	☐ The Blue Hole ☐ The Maya road ☐ Jungle, then reef
Dive or snorkel	☐ Certified diver ☐ Snorkel ☐ Stay dry, thanks
Something to celebrate	

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A LAST WORD FROM JAMES

Jane, that's Belize as I first saw it in 2006, and as it is now. Circle what moves you, cross out what doesn't, and send it back to me. I'll read every mark and call you with a plan: jungle first, then the reef, and Tikal if you'll let me talk you into it.

Til our next expedition, James

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THREE WAYS TO START

BUILD IT WITH IGGI
Iggi's Compass
jameswildco.com/voyages/belize

CALL OR TEXT JAMES
Talk it through
561.479.6355

WRITE TO JAMES
Send this page back
james@jameswildco.com

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MAPS Plates drawn by James Wild & Co. from Natural Earth public-domain data; reef line, atolls and routes are indicative.
SOURCES UNESCO World Heritage Centre (Belize Barrier Reef Reserve System); Statistical Institute of Belize (2022 Census); National Meteorological Service of Belize; Belize Tourism Board; US Department of State (March 2026); Central Bank of Belize; Panthera; Belize Audubon Society; operator and property listings (October 2026). Wildlife timing is guidance only.
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Til our next expedition

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